

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Table etiquette with Vanessa and Marco. Is Marco table savvy?



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have good table manners?
- What are some poor table manners you have seen?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about past habits.
- I can offer advice and suggestions.
- I can write about people's behavior and personality.



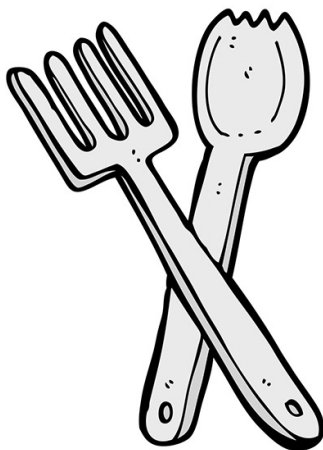


Let's Explore!

Listen to the conversation between Marco and Vanessa. How would you describe Marco's **table manners***? Is he **table savvy****?

* "Table manners" refers to someone's behavior while they are eating.

** "Table savvy" means knowing good table etiquette.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Hmm, this is delicious. The beef is so tender, and the caramelized apples were an unexpected treat!
- Marco:** I like to keep you on your toes ... You ought to make this recipe for your friends sometime. Plus, stir fries are healthy. I used to make high-fat meals more often than now.
- Vanessa:** Me, too. I have changed my eating habits. What is that?
- Marco:** It's my trusty spork. It's part of my cutlery collection. It's perfect for this kind of meal.
- Vanessa:** What! You actually use that thing ... in public?
- Marco:** Yes, I bring it with me wherever I go. It's always in my back pocket.
- Vanessa:** You are so unconventional. You had better not take that to any restaurant with me.
- Marco:** I do tend to swim against the tide. Even when I was little, I used to do my own thing and it would irritate my parents.
- Vanessa:** Sally says you definitely tend to stand out from the crowd.
- Marco:** I don't want to be just ordinary ... like you.
- Vanessa:** Don't be rude! You should learn some social etiquette.
- Marco:** I am what I am ... take it or leave it. What's dessert? Could you look in the fridge?
- Vanessa:** A cold shoulder.



Let's Practice!

Tell us about your past.

Instructions: Choose the sentences and write them into the correct category.

- I don't want to be just ordinary ... like you.
- I have changed my eating habits.
- I used to make high-fat meals more often than now.
- Even when I was little, I used to do my own thing.
- Don't be rude!
- You're so unconventional

Sentences that talk about past habits	Sentences that talk about personality



Let's Practice!

Can you give some suggestions?

Instructions: Mark with a circle all the correct suggestions.

1. You had better not take that to any restaurant with me.
2. You are so unconventional.
3. You definitely tend to stand out from the crowd.
4. You should learn some social etiquette.
5. I do tend to swim against the tide.
6. You ought to make this recipe for your friends sometime.
7. A cold shoulder.





Extension Activity

Does he swim against the tide?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 10-12 line dialogue between you and a friend.
- Have your friend describe the personality and behavior of a person they know. Do they have any bad habits? Are they unconventional?
- Give the friend some advice on how to react.
- Read the dialogue aloud with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue about personality and behavior.

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I give a friend some advice and suggestions.

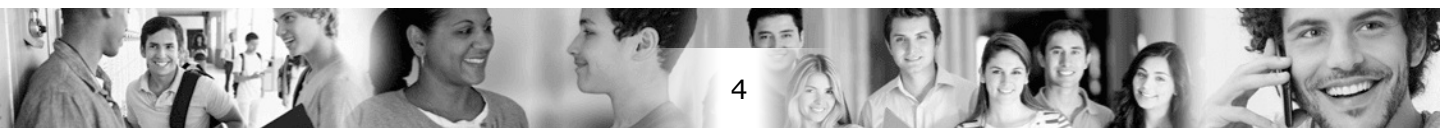
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I read a dialogue about behaviors aloud with a partner.

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Target Words

- caramelized** (adjective): cooked slowly until brown and sweet
e.g. The caramelized apples were an unexpected treat!
- on your toes** (expression): to maintain your attention and energy in one place
e.g. You always need to be on your toes with Marco.
- spork** (noun): an eating utensil that is both a spoon and a fork
e.g. Marco has a spork in his back pocket.
- unconventional** (adjective): not traditional or usual
e.g. His behavior was a little unconventional.
- to swim against the tide** (expression): to not follow others' ideas and beliefs
e.g. I tend to swim against the tide.
- to stand out from the crowd** (expression): to be different
e.g. I don't want to stand out from the crowd.
- social etiquette** (noun): behavior one has around others
e.g. Samuel has very poor social etiquette.
- cold shoulder** (expression): to not pay attention to someone for a reason, to ignore
e.g. Vanessa gave Marco a cold shoulder.
- appalling** (adjective): terrible, shocking
e.g. His behavior has been appalling.
- at one's wits' end** (expression): to be upset after trying every possible solution with no success
e.g. I am at my wits' end with Marco.





Learning Points

Writing a Letter

When you write a letter to a friend, you should include:

- A casual greeting like Dear Sally, or Hey Peter,
- Begin your letter with some general statements.
- Letters to friends are informal. Use appropriate language and contractions.
- Think about words you could use to link sentences together like *anyway*, *so* and *by the way*.
- An informal letter can also sound more like a conversation. For example: *Can you believe his behavior? I can't take him anywhere.*
- End your letter in an informal way like Love, or Cheers,

Examples:

- *What do you think I should do?*
- *I'll fill you in with the details when I see you next week.*

Talking About Past Habits (used to/would)

Would and **used to** have rather similar meanings. They are both used to describe something that happened regularly in the past but doesn't happen any longer. However, there is an important difference between **used to** and **would**.

Would is not used unless you know that the time frame is in the past, while **used to** does not require this.

Read the following example:

We used to visit India. (correct)

However, when **would** replaces **used to**, the same example becomes ungrammatical:

We would visit India. (not correct)

We would visit India every summer when we were children. (correct)

